

First Week After Pentecost

In Festo Ssmae Trinitatis

1962 TLM: Trinity Sunday; ferias may use the Mass of the First Sunday after Pentecost

Source note. In the 1962 Missale Romanum the Sunday after Pentecost is the feast of the Most Holy Trinity. The ferial Mass of the First Sunday after Pentecost begins *Domine, in tua misericordia speravi* and gathers the same post-Pentecost movement into mercy, charity, and judgment.

Proper	TLM text / reference	Scriptural axis	Fathers and saints	Connection
Introit	<i>Benedicta sit sancta Trinitas</i> (Tob. 12:6; Ps. 8)	Praise and mercy	St. Augustine, <i>De Trinitate</i> ; St. Gregory Nazianzen, theological orations	The Church begins ordinary growth after Pentecost by adoring the source of all mission: one God, three Persons.
Collect	Confession of true faith: know Trinity, adore unity	Faith seeking worship	St. Athanasius on Nicene confession; St. Thomas Aquinas, <i>Summa Theologiae</i> I, qq. 27-43	Doctrine is not abstract here; right confession becomes protection from adversity.
Epistle	Rom. 11:33-36	Incomprehensible wisdom	St. John Chrysostom on Romans; Augustine on divine simplicity	The apostle ends in doxology where reason reaches its limit: <i>ex ipso, per ipsum, in ipso</i> .
Gospel	Matt. 28:18-20	Baptismal name and mission	St. Hilary of Poitiers on Matthew; St. Leo the Great on Pentecost and mission	The Trinitarian name is the form of Christian rebirth and the grammar of evangelization.
Offertory	<i>Benedictus sit Deus Pater... Filius... Spiritus</i>	Mercy revealed	St. Bonaventure, <i>Itinerarium</i> ; St. Elizabeth of the Trinity	The offering is praise returned to the God whose mercy first descended.
Communion	<i>Benedicimus Deum caeli</i>	Public confession	St. Basil, On the Holy Spirit	Communion sends the worshipper from hidden mystery to public thanksgiving.
Ferial First Sunday	1 John 4:8-21; Luke 6:36-42	Charity and mercy	Augustine on 1 John; St. Benedict, Rule ch. 4	The ferial Mass unfolds Trinity into moral likeness: mercy because the Father is merciful.

Four Senses of Scripture

Thread	Synthesis
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Literal	Matthew 28 gives Christ's explicit command to baptize all nations in the one Name of the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost; Romans 11 confesses the unfathomable wisdom of God.
Allegorical	The baptismal Name reveals the mystery hidden in all salvation history: the Father sends the Son, and the Holy Ghost gathers the nations into the Church.
Moral	The ferial Gospel's command to be merciful shows the ethical fruit of Trinitarian life. The baptized must become merciful because he has been named by divine charity.
Anagogical	The doxology of Romans points beyond mission and moral effort to the final contemplation of God: <i>ex ipso, et per ipsum, et in ipso sunt omnia</i> .

Homily Sketch

Proposition. Pentecost does not end in activity first, but in adoration. The Spirit brings the Church into the confession of the Father, Son, and Holy Ghost; mission is born from worship.

Opening movement. Begin with the apparent surprise of the calendar: after the rushing wind of Pentecost, the Church places before us not a program but the mystery of God. The apostolic command in the Gospel, *docete omnes gentes*, is framed by the divine Name. We are sent because we have been named.

Doctrinal center. The Collect asks for two graces: to know the glory of the eternal Trinity and to adore the Unity in majesty. Knowledge and adoration must not be separated. A cold doctrine of God becomes sterile; devotion without truth becomes shapeless.

Moral turn. The ferial Mass of the First Sunday after Pentecost gives the ethical fruit: *Deus caritas est; Estote misericordes*. The Trinity is not a puzzle to solve but the source of charity to be imitated.

Exegetical Notes

- Romans 11 ends not with explanation but doxology. Paul's *O altitudo* teaches the preacher to let mystery remain mystery.
- Matthew 28 reveals that baptism is entry into the one divine Name, not into a private religious project.
- The ferial Gospel, Luke 6:36-42, guards Trinitarian orthodoxy from becoming censorious. The Father is merciful; the child must become merciful.

Witness	Short text	Homiletic use
St. Augustine	"You see the Trinity if you see charity." <i>De Trinitate</i> , VIII	Use this as the bridge from doctrine to life: charity is not a replacement for dogma but dogma made visible.
St. Athanasius	The Son is confessed as true God, not a creature elevated by favor.	The Gospel's baptismal formula only makes sense if the Son and Spirit belong to the divine life.
St. Basil	The Spirit is glorified with the Father and the Son.	Pentecost is completed by worship of the Spirit, not merely by invoking spiritual energy.
St. Elizabeth of the Trinity	Her prayer is to become a "praise of glory."	A contemplative application: the baptized person becomes a living doxology.

Thread	Synthesis
Trinity and mission	Pentecost gives the Spirit; Trinity Sunday names the divine life from which that gift proceeds. The Mass moves from confession to mission: the Church baptizes because she has first adored.
Mercy and doctrine	The ferial Gospel against judgment is not detached moralism. It is the ethical shape of Trinitarian faith: charity mirrors the God who first loved.
Creed and altar	The Introit blesses the Trinity; the Offertory returns the same blessing through sacrifice. The whole Mass is a Trinitarian act: to the Father, through the Son, in the Holy Ghost.
Prayer focus	Ask for firm faith that becomes merciful action, especially in speech, judgment, and fraternal correction.

Preaching Applications

- Correct false humility: the Trinity is beyond comprehension, but not beyond confession, adoration, and love.
- Invite the hearer to examine whether zeal for truth has become harshness toward the brother for whom Christ died.
- End with baptismal identity: every Christian life is signed by the Name into which it was baptized.

Primary References

- Missale Romanum 1962, Proprium de Tempore, *In Festo Smae Trinitatis; Missa Dominicae Primae post Pentecosten*.
- Local source: the 1962 temporal proper file listed in the project README.

Full Patristic and Sainly Texts

- St. Augustine, *De Trinitate*, VIII: “Nay, but you see the Trinity if you see love.”
- St. Augustine, Homily 7 on First John: “If you would not die of thirst in this wilderness, drink charity.”